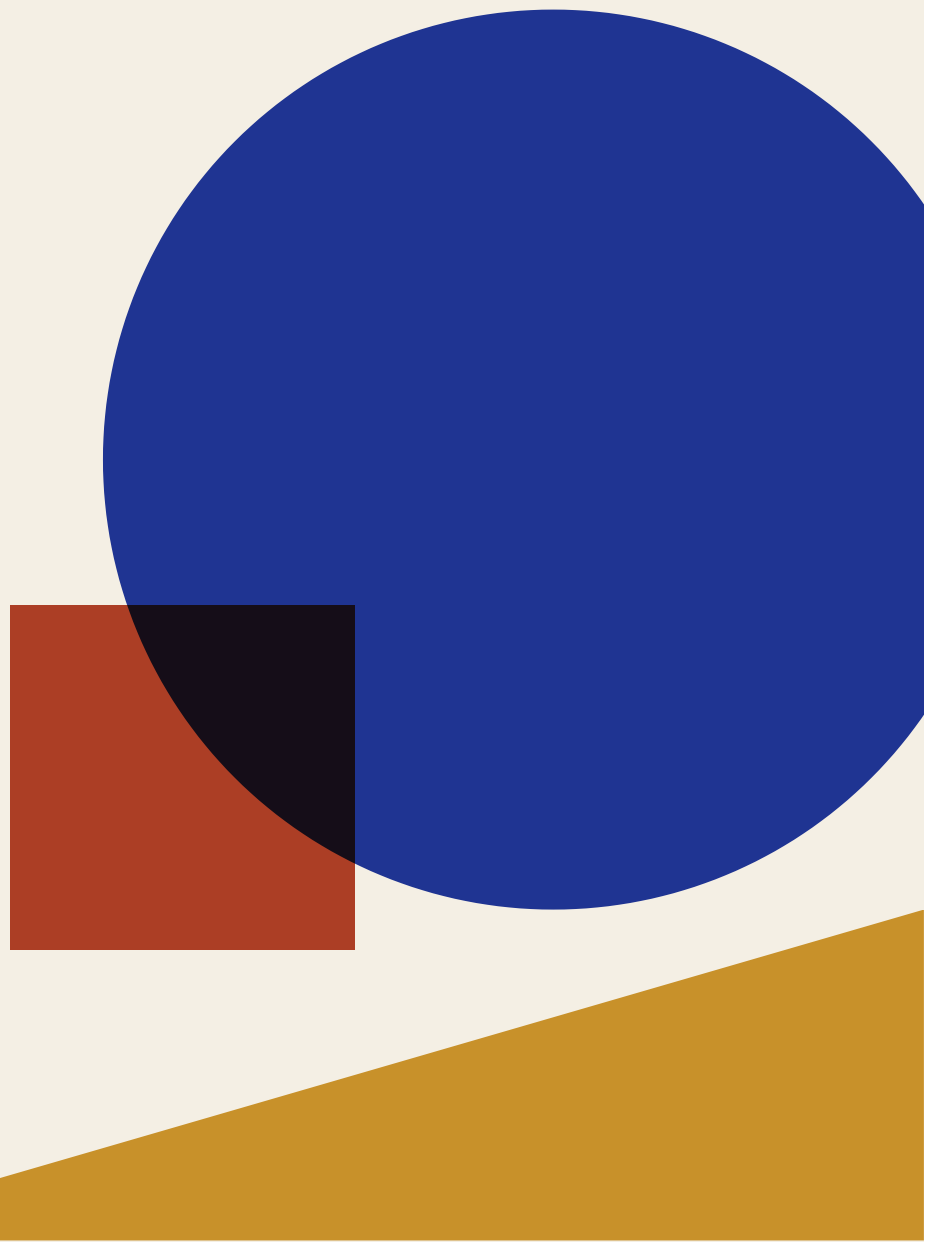




programme details

apaa patent surgery course 2026

3-6 november 2026

the landmark bangkok, thailand

HOSTED BY THE APAA RECOGNIZED GROUP OF THAILAND

ABOUT THE COURSE

an intensive practical course in patent drafting

Most of the patents we work on cross borders. What is drafted in one country is examined in several others, so it helps to know how the other side reads what we write. Most of us find that out only when something has gone wrong.

The Patent Surgery Course is APAA's intensive practical training course in patent drafting and prosecution. You draft, and four senior practitioners mark your work and mentor you through it.

Three and a half days in Bangkok, with tutors from Hong Kong, Australia and Japan. It is a working course, not a lecture series, built on practical exercises, group work and individual feedback. It closes with the APAA Trademark Caravan, a presentation and panel discussion moderated by Ben Fitzpatrick, with onsite access complimentary for course registrants.

who it is for

This course is for you if you:

- draft patent applications that will be examined in other jurisdictions, and want to know how they are read there
- respond to office actions, and want to see how claims are amended and arguments built without conceding more than you need to
- advise on freedom to operate, and would like a worked example of how that advice is structured, with its qualifications and its limits
- want to know where AI helps in drafting, in office actions and in prior art analysis, and where it does not

Open to anyone working with patents, in private practice, in-house or in a research institution, whether or not you are an APAA member. Taught in English.

THE PROGRAMME

the course outline

Eight topics over four days. The full agenda, with times and tutors, follows on the next four pages.

1	Typical parts of the patent application, and how each supports the claims	■ DAY 1
2	How to properly construe a patent	■ DAY 1
3	Patent claim drafting exercise, in groups, reviewed by the tutors	■ DAYS 1 AND 2
4	The use of AI in drafting specifications	■ DAY 2
5	Drafting techniques for global prosecution strategy	■ DAY 3
6	Dealing with complex office actions	■ DAY 3
7	How to advise on freedom to operate	■ DAY 3
8	AI in office actions and prior art analysis	■ DAY 4

1

day 1 / tuesday

3 November 2026

09:30-16:00

09:30-10:00 Welcome and inauguration

10:00-10:30 Course introduction

10:30-11:30

TOPIC 1

Typical parts of the patent application

The detailed description, drawings, background, abstract and summary, and how each of those sections supports the claims.

TUTOR Ben Fitzpatrick

11:30-11:45

Morning tea

11:45-12:30

TOPIC 2

How to properly construe a patent

The fundamental rules of construction, including purposive construction, followed by practical examples of how these principles are applied. The role of expert evidence in construction.

TUTOR Ben Fitzpatrick

12:30-13:30

Lunch

13:30-16:00

TOPIC 3

Patent claim drafting exercise

Participants draft claims to a patent specification in group exercises, assessed by the tutors. Each claim is checked to ensure it captures competing products, avoids unnecessary limitations, relates its elements to each other, overcomes the prior art and is industrially applicable. Particular focus on support and sufficiency, and the balance between broad claim scope and these internal requirements.

TUTORS Steven Fung, Ben Fitzpatrick, Greg Munt, Shigeru Inaba

16:00

Recap of day one and outline of day two

2

day 2 / wednesday

4 November 2026

09:30-16:00

09:30-11:00

TOPIC 3 CONTINUED

Patent claim drafting exercises

Participants draft a set of claims in groups, which the tutors then review individually.

11:00-11:15

Morning tea

11:15-12:30

TOPIC 3 CONTINUED

Drafting exercise

Groups continue the practical exercise, and each group presents its answer to the class.

12:30-13:30

Lunch

13:30-16:00

TOPIC 4

The use of AI in drafting specifications

Appropriate ways to use AI to assist in drafting specifications.

TUTOR **Steven Fung**

16:00

Recap of day two and outline of day three

3

day 3 / thursday

5 November 2026

09:30-16:00

09:30-11:00

TOPIC 5

Drafting techniques for global prosecution strategy

The specific requirements of particular jurisdictions, such as the EPO and the USPTO, and drafting strategies to address them.

TUTORS **Greg Munt, Steven Fung, Shigeru Inaba**

11:00-11:15

Morning tea

11:15-12:30

TOPIC 6

Dealing with complex office actions

Responding to complex office actions, including amending claims and developing arguments, with practical exercises.

TUTORS **Ben Fitzpatrick, Steven Fung, Greg Munt, Shigeru Inaba**

12:30-13:30

Lunch

13:30-16:00

TOPIC 7

How to advise on freedom to operate

How to structure the advice, including its necessary qualifications and limitations. Infringement and invalidity considerations. A worked practical example of a freedom-to-operate advice is provided.

TUTOR **Ben Fitzpatrick**

16:00

Recap of day three and outline of day four

4

day 4 / friday

6 November 2026

09:00-16:30

09:00-11:00

TOPIC 8

AI in office actions and prior art analysis

A continuation of Topic 4: handling an office action with AI, and analysing prior art documents with AI.

TUTOR **Steven Fung**

11:00-11:15

Morning tea

11:15-12:30

TOPIC 8 CONTINUED

AI in office actions and prior art analysis

TUTOR **Steven Fung**

12:30-13:30

Lunch

13:30-15:30

TRADEMARK CARAVAN

A presentation and panel discussion

Onsite access is complimentary for course registrants, with no separate registration needed. The topic and speakers will be announced.

MODERATOR **Ben Fitzpatrick**

15:30-16:30

Presentation of completion certificates

The programme may be subject to changes.

YOUR TUTORS

four senior practitioners, three jurisdictions



Steven Fung

TUTOR / HONG KONG / AUSTRALIA

A Hong Kong patent attorney with twenty years in practice, specialising in the drafting and prosecution of patent applications for universities, companies and government supported research organisations. His background is in computer engineering, and his work centres on AI, electronics, antennas and circuit design, control systems, and robotics and navigation. Working with Hong Kong universities and government funded research centres, he and his team have drafted, filed or obtained over 1,000 US patents and applications in the past decade.

Steven is a Patent Committee member of APAA Hong Kong and is well recognised in Hong Kong as a patent expert. He is a part-time and guest lecturer at the Chinese University of Hong Kong and City University of Hong Kong, teaching patent law, patent systems and patent drafting to engineering and science students, and lectures on intellectual property subjects at PolyU. He is active in the start-up community as a mentor on the HK Tech 300 programme and a vetting member of Cyberport's Entrepreneurship Committee Advisory Group.

He holds a Bachelor of Computer Engineering, a Bachelor of Laws, a Master of Commerce (Finance) and a Master of Industrial Property. He is a registered patent attorney in Australia and New Zealand, and a non-practising solicitor of the Supreme Court of New South Wales.



Ben Fitzpatrick

TUTOR / AUSTRALIA

A barrister at the Victorian Bar and a registered patent and trademark attorney, with twenty-five years specialising in patents and trademarks. He holds a first-class honours Bachelor of Science from Sydney University and an LLB from the University of New South Wales. He is a Senior Research Fellow at Melbourne University, where he has taught intellectual property for over ten years, including the Interpretation and Criticism of Patents course since 2015. Ben is married to Anne with three children and lives in Richmond, Melbourne, Australia.



Shigeru Inaba

TUTOR / JAPAN

A partner at Sayagata IP, a boutique intellectual property firm, and a Japanese patent attorney of almost 35 years in private practice. His work is principally patent prosecution in a broad range of technical fields, including mechanical engineering, architecture, construction, electrical engineering, electronics, and ICT. He taught university-level courses in patent law and intellectual property to engineering students for many years. He currently serves as Secretary General of APAA.



Greg Munt

TUTOR / AUSTRALIA

A registered Australian and New Zealand patent and trademarks attorney with a Bachelor of Engineering (Materials). He trained at a major Australian firm, spent three years in-house at a global mining and steelmaking company, then returned to private practice and was a partner for 36 years. Greg now contracts back to the firm.

Greg's practice has centred on working for a small group of Australian clients, most having global business operations. A major part of the work has been drafting patent specifications, filing the specifications with patent applications in Australia and elsewhere, and prosecuting the applications to patent grant. Another major part of the work for these clients has been conducting patent searches and providing freedom-to-operate opinions. Greg is a Past President of the Asian Patent Attorneys Association.

FEES AND REGISTRATION

registration fee

	THB	USD
APAA member	15,000	500
Non-member	18,000	600
Thailand Recognized Group member A subsidised rate, 25% below the APAA member fee	11,250	

The subsidised rate is open to all Thailand Recognized Group members, including new members, who can join through the course registration form. The fee covers course materials, lunch and refreshments each day, a certificate of completion, and complimentary onsite access to the Trademark Caravan. It does not include accommodation or travel.

REGISTRATION

how to register

- 1** Complete the online registration form.
- 2** We issue an invoice within three working days. Invoices are issued in THB or USD, at the registrant's choice.
- 3** Payment by bank transfer secures your seat.

REGISTER ONLINE

[Open the registration form →](#)

Fees are non-refundable, including cancellation or no-show. Bank charges, including any intermediary bank charges, are borne by the attendee.

Seats are limited to 50, shared by participants from Thailand and abroad. Registration closes on 19 October 2026.

BEFORE YOU TRAVEL

practical information

VENUE

The Landmark Bangkok, 138 Sukhumvit Road, Khlong Toei, Bangkok 10110, Thailand. The hotel is one to two minutes on foot from Nana station on the BTS Skytrain, Bangkok's elevated rail line, and parking is available.

ACCOMMODATION

Accommodation is not included in the fee. Information on room rates at The Landmark Bangkok is available on request.

LANGUAGE

The course is taught in English.

CONTACT

apaapsc2026@eml.nishimura.com

For questions about the course, registration or accommodation, contact the organising committee.

APAA RECOGNIZED GROUP OF THAILAND